



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

prajñā+ambu+vegāṃ sthira+śīla+vaprāṃ* |*
samādhi+śītāṃ vrata+cakra+vākām |*
*asya*uttamāṃ* dharma+nadīm pravṛttām |*
trṣṇā+ārditaḥ pāsyati jīva+lokaḥ || 1.71 |
duḥkha+ārditebhyo viṣaya+āvṛtebhyaḥ |*
saṃsāra+kāntāra+patha+sthitebhyaḥ |
ākhyāsyati hy eṣa* vimokṣa+mārgaṃ* |*
mārga+pranaṣṭebhya iva*adhva+gebhyaḥ || 1.72 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 1, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Imagine a mighty river, not of water, but of wisdom (prajñā), its currents swift and strong. This river is contained by the firm banks of moral conduct (śīla), ensuring its flow remains pure and directed. The cool depths of this river represent meditative stillness (samādhi), offering respite from the burning heat of worldly desires. The flocks of birds circling above are akin to vows (vrata), commitments that guide and uplift us on our spiritual journey. This, the scripture proclaims, is the supreme river of Dharma, ready to quench the thirst of all beings (jīva-loka) parched by craving (trṣṇā).

Consider how deeply ingrained our thirst for external validation and material possessions is. This verse reminds you that lasting satisfaction can only be found within, by turning to the Dharma.

The second verse paints a vivid picture of suffering. Humanity, afflicted by sorrow (duḥkha) and blinded by sensory pleasures (viṣaya), is lost in the desolate wilderness (kāntāra) of samsara, the cycle of birth and death. Like travelers who have lost their way, we wander aimlessly, burdened by our pain. But the Buddha, through his teachings, offers a path to liberation (vimokṣa-mārga), a clear and direct route out of the wilderness. He is the guide who points the way, illuminating the path for those who have become lost.

This resonates profoundly in our modern world, where many feel lost and overwhelmed by the complexities of life. The Buddha's teachings offer a compass, helping you navigate the challenges and find your way back to inner peace and purpose. His path provides a framework for cultivating wisdom, compassion, and ethical conduct, essential tools for living a meaningful life even amidst the chaos. He invites you to step out of the wilderness of your mind, and begin the journey toward enlightenment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you cultivate more stillness and wisdom in your daily life, to better navigate the challenges of the modern world and find your way back to your true self?